

tab if available (not all drivers are designed with similar front ends) and turn off vertical sync.

■ Enable fog table emulation

Checking this option will allow certain games that improperly access fog to make use of it, albeit with a performance hit. Disable this option when running newer games with full fog support. It will look better and run

through your video card's drivers only if you have additional performance to spare.

■ PCI Texture Memory Size

Since the majority of 3D cards use the AGP bus, it's absolutely pointless to set aside memory space for PCI textures. Set this option to zero, again in your video card drivers, to save memory space and to slightly boost performance.

■ Buffer flipping mode

If this option is available, set it to automatic in your 3D accelerator's drivers. By doing this, you will allow the driver to automatically detect the best method based upon your hardware configuration.

■ Adjusting colour depth

The more colour you use, the more processing power will it take to render 3D scenes. If the only thing that matters to you is speed and more speed, you'll find that the maximum benefit lies in switching to 16-bit colour mode in all the games that you play.

■ Motherboards drivers

More than being just functional patches, driver updates for motherboards can deliver rather large jumps in system performance, especially if the drivers contain fixes for

major issues. Irrespective of which chipset your motherboard is based upon, there are a few thumb rules for optimising driver related settings for peak performance:

■ Before installing a fresh set of new drivers, uninstall the existing set. Do this from **Control Panel > Add or Remove Programs**. Select the drivers that you wish to remove and click the 'Remove' button. Thus you can ensure that only the new files are installed and there is no trace of the old ones. The same goes for video

cards and soundcards too.

■ When you install an updated driver set, pay close attention to the steps you have to go through. For example, the VIA 4-in-1 drivers, on installing a file, query you as to which corresponds to the proper working of AGP. To questions like these, always select the choice, which reads 'High Performance'. Remember, the decision you make in each of those installation steps will have an influence on how fast your computer system runs.

ADVENTURES WITH OSS

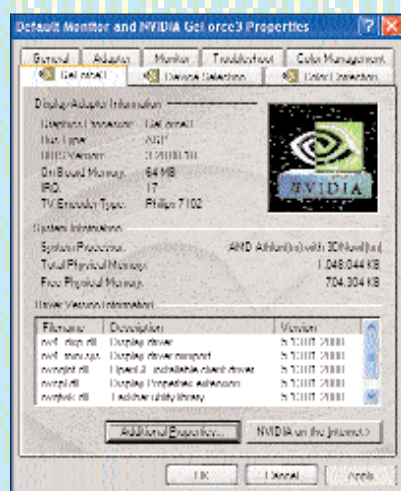
A few clean-ups and tweaks can get you OS on a roll



■ Start me up!

Let's get right down to the beginning. The first method by which you can get Windows to load faster is by

streamlining the startup process. While in Windows, choose **Start > Run**, type **sysedit** which will launch the System Configuration Editor.



nVidia's drivers keep a tab on versions of each file.

smoothly, too. You can normally disable fog emulation from the Direct3D and OpenGL tabs within your video card's driver software.

■ Enable anisotropic filtering

If you want at least some level of visual quality, anisotropic filtering is perhaps the smoothest filtering method available. It definitely results in sweeter images, but enable this option